

Sandor Santos

My project will be an informational website combining statistical and ideas about the inequality of people of color. Topics:

- Mass incarceration and state repression, at a historical level
- Economic inequality and critiques of racial capitalism

Book: **Fenderson-Expanding the History of the Black Studies Movement**

Sources:

- Are Prisons Obsolete? - Angela Y. Davis
https://decolonisesociology.com/wp-content/uploads/2019/03/angela-davis-are_prisons_obsolete.pdf
- The Sentencing Project
<https://www.sentencingproject.org/>
- How Black Communities Built Their Own Schools - JSTORE
<https://daily.jstor.org/how-black-communities-built-their-own-schools/>
- A War within Our Own Boundaries - Elizabeth Hinton
https://lsa.umich.edu/content/dam/sid-assets/SID%20Docs/Hinton,%20_A%20War%20Within%20Our%20own%20Boundaries_.pdf
- Examining the Black-White Wealth Gap - Brookings Institution
<https://www.brookings.edu/articles/examining-the-black-white-wealth-gap/>

HOME PAGE - Black Studies, State Power, and Racial Capitalism: Enduring Discrimination

Stewart Fenderson argues that Black Studies emerged during a period of expanding state repression and restructuring racial capitalism.

State repression:

refers to the use of government power to control, suppress, monitor, or punish individuals or groups that are perceived as threatening to political, economic, or social order. It involves institutions such as police departments, courts, prisons, intelligence agencies, and legislative bodies.

- Surveillance of political activists
- Criminalization of protest
- Expanded policing in specific communities

- Harsh sentencing laws
- Suppression of radical or oppositional movements

The formation of Black Studies programs was not simply about representation in the academy. It was a response to intensifying systems of surveillance, policing, incarceration, and economic exclusion that reshaped Black life in the late twentieth century.

Mass incarceration and the racial wealth gap are not separate crises. They are interconnected outcomes of state policy, economic restructuring, and racial influence in law practices.

Why This History Matters

Contemporary data from The Sentencing Project and the Brookings Institution shows that racial disparities in incarceration and wealth are still an ongoing issue (information up to 2024). Understanding their historical development allows us to see that these inequalities are structural rather than accidental.

Brookings Institution, median white household wealth dramatically exceeds median Black household wealth and shows:

- Generational asset accumulation differences
- Housing discrimination
- Unequal access to credit
- Labor market discrimination

Their data on net worths will be included on the website along with its connections to its intersection with incarceration statistics from The Sentencing Project

The JSTOR Daily article on Black communities building their own schools highlights a long tradition of separating the institution side of racial discrimination.

A Grade:

1. A clear, arguable thesis
2. Strong historical Continuity
3. Use of data to support
4. Clear navigation structure